Practice Papers 1 and 2 with Answer Keys

Parents' Guide (revised March 2025)

All 63 of the N. Ireland post-primary schools which use academic selection for all or part of their Year 8 Admissions Criteria have come together to form SEAG and to provide an Entrance Assessment, the outcomes of which can be considered by those schools within their Admissions Criteria.

The Entrance Assessment is available to sit in all 63 SEAG schools across N. Ireland for pupils whose parents want them to have the opportunity to sit the Assessment and have registered them by making a Pupil Application. Pupils who have been registered to sit the Entrance Assessment sit two papers in November which both assess English(or Irish) and Mathematics.

SEAG and GL Assessment worked together to produce two official Practice Papers along with Answer Sheets for pupils who will be sitting the Assessment in English to use and two official Practice Papers for pupils who will be sitting the Assessment in Irish to use. There is also this Parents' Guide with Answer Keys for all the Practice Papers. Both Practice Papers and both Answer Sheets are available at no cost to parents. Parents can be assured that these are the only official SEAG/GL Practice Papers 1 and 2 and Answer Sheets, commissioned by SEAG and produced by GL Assessment to follow the format of an actual SEAG Entrance Assessment paper. These papers and the Answer Sheets have the GL Assessment logo on the front page.

You should be aware that there are no Practice Papers produced by any other company which have been commissioned or approved by SEAG or by GL Assessment. It is easy to spot a "Practice Paper" which is not actually an approved SEAG/GL Practice Paper because it will not have the GL Assessment logo.

About the Practice Papers:

When pupils sit a SEAG Entrance Assessment they will be marked on the 28 English (or Gaeilge) questions and on the 28 Maths questions in each Paper.

Before starting the actual paper, each pupil is given the opportunity to practise with 5 "warm-up" English (or Gaeilge) "Practice Test" questions (P1-P5) and 5 "warm-up" Maths "Practice Test" questions (P6-P10).

The Practice Papers and the actual SEAG Entrance Assessment Papers each have three Sections:

Practice Test

English (or Gaeilge) Main Test

Maths Main Test

Practice Test:

- Each English (or Gaeilge) Practice Test consists of a punctuation question *(P1)*, a grammar question *(P2*), a spelling question *(P3)*, a very short passage and two comprehension questions *(P4-P5*). P1-P4 are multiple choice and P5 is "free response".
- The Maths Practice Test consists of five questions *(P6-P10)*. P6-P8 are multiple choice and P9-P10 are "free response".
- The Practice Test Section is not marked or timed in the SEAG Entrance Assessment.

English (or Gaeilge) Main Test:

- The English (or Gaeilge) Main Test Section of the Practice Papers begins with a **"Punctuation Exercise"** containing 5 multiple choice questions *(Questions 1-5)*. If there is a mistake, the pupil identifies whether it is in the group of words at A, B, C or D. If there is no mistake, the answer is "N".
- Next is a **"Grammar Exercise"** which also has 5 multiple choice questions *(Questions 6-10)*.
  Pupils choose the best word or group of words to complete a sentence so that the passage makes sense and is written in correct English. There are 5 words (or groups of words) A, B, C, D or E to choose from.
- The third part is a **"Spelling Exercise"** also with 5 multiple choice questions *(Questions 11-15).*
  If there is a mistake, the pupil identifies whether it is in the group of words at A, B, C or D. If there is no mistake, the answer is "N".
- Finally, there is an "English (or Gaeilge) Comprehension". Pupils are asked to read a passage and are then asked 13 questions *(Questions 16-28).* The first 7 of these are multiple choice with A, B, C, D or E answers from which pupils choose the best option. The final 6 questions are described as "free response" because the pupil writes the answer in the space provided in the Answer Sheet.
- Spelling is only assessed in the Spelling Exercise and not in the 6 free response questions. e.g. If the answer is "adjective" then answers such as "ajective", "adjectif" and "ajectiv" would be accepted.

Maths Main Test:

- There are 28 questions *(Questions 29-56)*. The first 22 are multiple choice where the pupil chooses the correct answer from 5 possible answers A, B, C, D or E. Where possible, he Answer Sheet provides each of the possible multiple choice answers beside its letter.
  e.g. if the options are **A** 8, **B** 3, **C** 6, **D** 4, **E** 2, the Answer Sheet provides the possible answers beside the letters.
- The final 6 Maths questions *(Questions 51-56)* are described as "free response". For each of these questions the pupil works out the correct answer and writes the answer in the space provided in the Answer Sheet.

Answer Sheet:

It is recommended that parents and pupils are familiar with the Answer Sheet before a pupil begins to use it.

NB Each Practice Paper has its own unique Answer Sheet - The Answer Sheet for Practice Paper 1 cannot be used with Practice Paper 2 or vice-versa.

- The top part of the Answer Sheet is set out just as it would be in the actual SEAG Entrance Assessment with spaces for details about the pupil, where the Assessment is taking place and the date of the test.
- The English (or Gaeilge) Practice Test P1-P5 answer boxes are clearly set out on one line followed by the Maths Practice Test P6-P10 answer boxes.
- Then follows the first 22 multiple choice answer boxes for the English Main Test.
- The second page starts with spaces for the final 6 "free response" comprehension questions.
- Next come the first 22 multiple choice answer boxes for the Maths Main Test followed by spaces for the final 6 "free response" Maths questions.

How the Practice Papers can be used. There are essentially two approaches:

1) Using them to gain experience at sitting SEAG/GL type Entrance Assessment Papers and Answer Sheets under timed "examination" conditions.

2) Using them, without timing, to gain experience at answering SEAG/GL type questions, using the Answer Sheets.

In both approaches it is really important that pupils are reminded to read the instructions very carefully. They should have an HB pencil to write their answers and a blank page for rough work.

NB When sitting the actual SEAG Entrance Assessment, or a Practice Paper, pupils are free to bring a highlighter and to use it on the Question Paper and rough work page but NOT on the Answer Sheet.

Under approach **2** a pupil could attempt a full paper in one session or spread the work out over several sessions. The paper doesn't need to be timed. The person supervising the pupil can use the Practice Test part to check that the pupil has been filling in the Answer Sheet correctly. That means answering Question P1 in the Question P1 answer box, Question P2 in the Question P2 answer box, etc. making sure that the horizontal lines which the pupil uses to answer multiple choice questions are drawn in the little boxes provided.

After a Practice Paper has been completed you can use its Answer Key, provided in this Guide, to check over each answer. There may be a temptation to just count the number of correct answers, but it is more helpful to look at any questions which were answered incorrectly, go over what the correct answer is and why.

Under approach **1** a Practice Test section can also be used to check that the pupil has been filling in the Answer Sheet correctly before he / she starts the Main Test.

The main difference between approaches **1** and **2** is that, in approach **1,** the Main Test will be timed. The Practice Test section does not need to be timed. Under both approaches pupils should do the Practice Test (P1-P10) before beginning the actual Main Test.

If timing a SEAG Practice Paper, 60 minutes should be allowed, after the Practice Test section has been completed, to answer the 56 questions. Pupils should be able to see a clock. They can be told at the start of the 60 minutes the time at which the test will end. They should be allowed to work quietly through the paper.

A pupil can start either with the English Main Test Section (Q1-Q28) and then go on to the Maths Main Test OR with the Maths (Q29-Q56) and then go back to the English.

After 30 minutes you can indicate the time and suggest that the pupil(s) should be moving on to the other Section (if that has not already been started); after 50 minutes you could say something like "you have 10 minutes left".

Pupils who will be allowed additional time in the Entrance Assessment, (through an approved Access Arrangement) should also be allowed extra time when sitting a Practice Paper.

Advice to pupils when using a Practice Paper and Answer Sheet:

- You may not be able to do all the questions, but try to do as many as you can. If you are not sure of the answer, choose the one you think is best.
- Make sure you keep your place on the Answer Sheet. Find the answer box with the correct question number, then find the letter you have chosen as your answer and draw a horizontal line in the answer box beside the letter.
- Remember to draw a firm line, in pencil, clearly in the answer box to make your answer. If you make a mistake, rub it out as completely as you can and put in your new answer.

Practice Paper 1

ANSWER KEY

English: Practice Test		Maths: Practice Test	
P1	D	P6	E – 3:25
P2	C	P7	D – 45
P3	A	P8	A – 108
P4	B	P9	6 days
P5	cosy	P10	2 cm

English: Main Test		Maths: Main Test	
Q1	C	Q29	E – 247
Q2	A	Q30	B – 3
Q3	C	Q31	A – Equilateral triangle
Q4	N	Q32	A – 1/3
Q5	B	Q33	B – 8 glasses
Q6	C	Q34	D – 17, 22
Q7	B	Q35	C – 1/9
Q8	A	Q36	D – £1.60
Q9	B	Q37	B – 0.25
Q10	D	Q38	B – Tamlyn 12 g more
Q11	D	Q39	D – 24
Q12	A	Q40	B – -9°C
Q13	N	Q41	D – £12.27
Q14	B	Q42	D – 60%
Q15	C	Q43	A – 300 g
Q16	E	Q44	A – 270 minutes
Q17	A	Q45	B – 1421
Q18	C	Q46	D – 8 m
Q19	E	Q47	A – 12 years
Q20	D	Q48	A – (3, 1)
Q21	E	Q49	B – 95 p
Q22	B	Q50	C – Jacob
Q23	three OR 3	Q51	5.7 kg
Q24	silk	Q52	20 minutes
Q25	concealed	Q53	13 m
Q26	disappeared	Q54	260 km
Q27	preposition(s)	Q55	58 triangles
Q28	noun(s)	Q56	5 biscuits

Practice Paper 2

ANSWER KEY

English: Practice Test		Maths: Practice Test	
P1	D	P6	A – PE
P2	A	P7	D – 46p
P3	B	P8	D – 680
P4	D	P9	4 eighths *(accept 4/8, 4/8^{ths}, 4 x 1/8)*
P5	flung	P10	3 cars

English: Main Test		Maths: Main Test	
Q1	C	Q29	D – 4 pm
Q2	B	Q30	B – B
Q3	A	Q31	D – 9
Q4	N	Q32	D – £5.92
Q5	B	Q33	A – (16 , 10)
Q6	A	Q34	D – Dan
Q7	B	Q35	C – Joanne
Q8	C	Q36	C – 10/25
Q9	E	Q37	A – sixteen 20p coins
Q10	D	Q38	A – 0.82 m
Q11	B	Q39	C – Thursday
Q12	A	Q40	B – 7
Q13	D	Q41	A – 2.7%
Q14	N	Q42	C – millilitres
Q15	C	Q43	C – 1/3
Q16	C	Q44	E – 40
Q17	E	Q45	A – 1/4
Q18	B	Q46	B – The milk is 9°C too cold.
Q19	A	Q47	B – 1/2
Q20	D	Q48	E – 864
Q21	C	Q49	E - $16.50
Q22	D	Q50	B – 123
Q23	40 *or* forty	Q51	28 matches
Q24	at night *(accept night, (at) night-time or any other inclusion of the word 'night' providing the intention is clear)*	Q52	6.62 m *(the decimal point must be clearly visible for a mark to be awarded)*
Q25	anything but simple	Q53	7 h 50 min *(accept 470 min)*
Q26	drones had never been flown before	Q54	975 g
Q27	traditionally, recently, completely *(any order acceptable)*	Q55	8 vertices
Q28	noun(s) *(accept misspellings, providing the intention is clear)*	Q56	4 cm

PÁIPÉAR CLEACHTA 1 (Gaeilge)

EOCHAIR FREAGRAÍ

Gaeilge: Teist Chleachta		Mata: Teist Chleachta	
c1	D	c6	E – 3:25
c2	C	c7	D – 45
c3	A	c8	A – 108
c4	B	c9	6 lá
c5	thaistil	c10	2 cm

Gaeilge: Príomhtheist		Mata: Príomhtheist	
C1	C	C29	E – 247
C2	A	C30	B – 3
C3	C	C31	A – Triantán Comhshleasach
C4	N	C32	A – 1/3
C5	B	C33	B – 8 ngloine
C6	C	C34	D – 17, 22
C7	B	C35	C – 1/9
C8	A	C36	D – £1.60
C9	B	C37	B – 0.25
C10	D	C38	B – Tara 12g níos mó
C11	D	C39	D – 24
C12	A	C40	B – -9°C
C13	N	C41	D – £12.27
C14	B	C42	D – 60%
C15	C	C43	A – 300 g
C16	E	C44	A – 270 bomaite
C17	A	C45	B – 1421
C18	C	C46	D – 8 m
C19	E	C47	A – 12 bhliain
C20	D	C48	A – (3, 1)
C21	E	C49	B – 95 p
C22	B	C50	C – Seán
C23	réiltín	C51	5.7 kg
C24	iasc	C52	20 bomaite
C25	ghabh sí	C53	13 m
C26	ceangailte de chéimeanna an charbháin NÓ céimeanna an charbháin NÓ an carbhán	C54	260 km
C27	briathra	C55	58 triantán
C28	ar feadh	C56	5 bhriosca

PÁIPÉAR CLEACHTA 2 (Gaeilge)

EOCHAIR FREAGRAÍ

Gaeilge: Teist Chleachta		Mata: Teist Chleachta	
c1	D	c6	A – Corpoideachas
c2	A	c7	D – 46p
c3	B	c8	D – 680
c4	D	c9	4 ochtú *(glac le 4/8, 4/8ú, 4 x 1/8)*
c5	sionnach	c10	3 charr

Gaeilge: Príomhtheist		Mata: Príomhtheist	
C1	C	C29	D – 4 i.n.
C2	B	C30	B – B
C3	A	C31	D – 9
C4	N	C32	D – £5.92
C5	B	C33	A – (16 , 10)
C6	A	C34	D – Domhnall
C7	B	C35	C – Siobhán
C8	C	C36	C – 10/25
C9	E	C37	A – 16 bhonn 20
C10	D	C38	A – 0.82 m
C11	B	C39	C – Déardaoin
C12	A	C40	B – 7
C13	D	C41	A – 2.7%
C14	N	C42	C – Millilítir
C15	C	C43	C – 1/3
C16	C	C44	E – 40
C17	E	C45	A – 1/4
C18	B	C46	B – Tá an bainne 9ºC rófhuar.
C19	A	C47	B – 1/2
C20	D	C48	E – 864
C21	C	C49	E - $16.50
C22	D	C50	B – 123
C23	Dreach fíochmhar	C51	28 cluiche
C24	Go mall, fadálach	C52	6.62 m *(Ní mór don phointe deachúlach a bheith le feiceáil le marc a fháil)*
C25	Le héalú ó chontúirt (éigin)	C53	7 uair 50 bom *(glac le 470 bom)*
C26	Ag creathnú agus ag snagáil	C54	975 g
C27	Ainmfhocail	C55	8 rinn
C28	Os cionn a chloiginn	C56	4 cm